

screens, keyboards, etc. They seem to now be open to an idea of replacing a gaming PC with a gaming laptop to gain mobility. But, the price points are still on the higher side?

Patel: The response to the launch has been phenomenal. With our product range starting at just ₹79,990/- we have ensured our consumers have various options across price points in the gaming portfolio itself. We have especially created competitive pricing to ensure quality and affordable gaming experience for our customers.

Q Besides gamers, which other segment do HP Omen laptops and desktops mainly appeal to?

Patel: It is primarily targeting towards gaming, the lesser expensive machine can be used for entertainment purposes and students can use for productivity also. The machines are equipped with best in class entertainment focused specifications like high HD visuals and quality surround sound.

Q You are launching an HP Omen desktop that is priced around ₹1.4L in India. Tell us something on the target audience and how it competes with assembled

gaming desktops that are far cheaper

Patel: The Omen desktop is targeted for serious gamers and it is enabled with uncompromised performance coupled with the best in class graphic card, processor, and thermal cooling. We are the best placed vendor in India today and we are here to deliver the best a gamer can get and offer value for money.

Q Apart from performance and other core elements, gaming laptops are also about experience, personalization and #swag appeal. How does the Omen series cater to these needs?

Patel: We have designed the Omen devices taking the style and comfort into consideration. With a neat design, we have ensured that the performance of the machine does not get compromised. In terms of personalization, we have launched Omen accessories which will allow a gamer to personalize his/ her machine. The accessories launched include OMEN Keyboard with SteelSeries, OMEN Headset with SteelSeries, OMEN Mouse with SteelSeries and OMEN Mouse Pad with SteelSeries.

Q How big is the Gaming Laptop market in India and how has the response been

so far in terms of units sold, etc.?

Patel: The gaming market in India is two-fold. If we look at casual gamers in India, it is almost 50% of the current notebook segment while the serious gaming market is just 2%. However, if combined it makes 50% of the total market. Therefore, apart from our flagship range of products like Spectre, Pavilion, we want Omen to cater to this unexplored market where there is huge opportunity for growth.

Q VR seems to be the buzzword in gaming, but it is also an expensive affair with true VR gear costing as much or even more than a gaming laptop. Does that impact the marketability and appeal of 'VR' ready laptops in the Omen series?

Patel: The need for VR is subjective, if a person is buying a VR enabled gaming laptop, this does not necessarily mean he would want it only for VR purpose, he may be buying it for gaming, entertainment, for other facilities. VR is an added experience to enhance and upgrade the gaming experience. Therefore, to give that value addition, HP has partnered with companies like PVR which will be using our OMEN products specially for VR experience and create an exciting experience for our users. **Q**

JUMP ONTO THE DIGITAL BANDWAGON

The Digit e-mag app is now listed on app stores

Head over to the links below and download the app right now. Try a few issues and give us your feedback.

digit
INSIDER PROGRAMME



<http://digit.in/DGTDroid>



<http://digit.in/DGTiOS>



Download



Download



Download



Download



All buyers of the print mag get the corresponding emag issue for free*

Go to this URL to claim your free emag issue:
<http://digit.in/dfreemag>

*Android only